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Bears eye summer stadium decision

CEO still waiting for Illinois lawmakers to OK property tax deal

By Robert McCoppin and Phil Thompson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Chicago Bears leaders said Wednesday they want a quick resolution to their search for a new stadium, with a goal of opening a new enclosed stadium by 2030 — either in Arlington Heights or Indiana.

Team President and CEO Kevin Warren put a rough timeline on plans to build a new enclosed stadium, hoping to choose a site by this spring or summer, he told reporters at the NFL owners meeting in Phoenix on Wednesday.

“I mean, the costs are going up,” Warren said. “The financial markets are, they’re, because of the war (in Iran), all the different things we have going on, they can be a little uncertain. So it’s time for us to make a decision, and then to be able to finish the design, based upon the location and be in a position to build and open up by 2030.”

Team officials still are waiting for Illinois lawmakers to approve a proposal that would let the Bears negotiate long-term property tax breaks with local schools and other governmental agencies for a site in Arlington Heights. Gov. JB Pritzker has endorsed the team’s plan to build its own \$2 billion stadium, while the state would pay an estimated \$855 million for roads and other infrastructure — but Chicago lawmakers are reluctant to help the team leave the city.

As an alternative, Indiana lawmakers last month authorized building a new stadium in Hammond, with the team kicking in \$2 billion and the state using new taxes to pay about \$1 billion. Bears officials are doing

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CHICAGO HOUSING AUTHORITY

Board chair fights ouster

Johnson stands by decision to remove leader of panel that defied his wishes on new CEO

By Alice Yin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson on Wednesday removed the Chicago Housing Authority board chair from his leadership position after

the mayorally appointed body openly revolted against him last month in installing a new CEO.

In a statement, Johnson said he demoted CHA board chair Matthew Brewer because the mayor believes the appointment

of Keith Pettigrew to be the next leader of the nation’s third-largest housing agency violated state law.

“(Brewer’s) stewardship of this process disenfranchised both fellow Commissioners and the communities the CHA serves,” Johnson wrote. “CHA residents deserve leadership decisions that are transparent, lawful, and grounded in their lived experi-

ences, not a process that prioritizes expediency over accountability. ... Any actions taken or agreements entered into under Mr. Brewer’s claimed authority are invalid and without legal effect.”

Johnson named CHA board member Jawanza Malone to succeed Brewer as chair, per his

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STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

An oath to serve the city

Chicago police Superintendent Larry Snelling, right, salutes newly promoted Officer Adrianna Grenier during a graduation ceremony at Navy Pier on Tuesday. A new study mandated by the federal consent decree and released Wednesday urges the department to hire hundreds of new officers among other changes meant to increase its ability to respond to emergencies. **Chicagoland, Page A3**



Immigrant’s ‘harsh reality’

Roosevelt student set goal to run every street in Chicago and inspired a city. Now he might be forced to leave the country

By Audrey Pachuta | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Joabe Barbosa used to tell people his appetite for exploration drove his quest to become the first person to run every street in the city of Chicago.

Now, after learning his F-1 student visa status might force him to leave the place he has called home since 2022 and return to his native Brazil, he recognizes it has always been the sense of community compelling him to keep moving.

“I’m not born in Chicago, I

Joabe Barbosa shows off the Chicago flag he wears as he attempts to run every street in the city.

TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/
TRIBUNE

haven’t lived in Chicago for five years,” Barbosa said. “But I love Chicago more than people who have lived in Chicago for over 50 years.”

Since he began running in August 2024 to rehabilitate after an injury, he has traversed 85% of more than 4,000 miles of Chicago’s streets, he said, tracking his progress on an app. By late last year, he knew he could

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High court wary of limits on birthright citizenship

By Mark Sherman
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court seemed poised Wednesday to reject President Donald Trump’s restrictions on birthright citizenship in a consequential case that was magnified by his unparalleled presence in the courtroom.

Conservative and liberal justices questioned whether Trump’s order declaring that children born to parents who are in the United States illegally or temporarily are not American citizens comports with either the Constitution or federal law.

Arguments lasted more than two hours in a crowded courtroom that included not only Trump, the first sitting president to attend arguments at the nation’s highest court, but also

Attorney General Pam Bondi and Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick, and in seats reserved for the justices’ guests, actor Robert De Niro.

After court adjourned, Trump posted on Truth Social: “We are the only Country in the World STUPID enough to allow ‘Birth-right’ Citizenship!” Actually, about three dozen countries, nearly all of them in the Americas, guarantee citizenship to children born on their territory.

The Republican administration’s top Supreme Court lawyer, Solicitor General D. John Sauer, faced one skeptical question after another. Justices asked about the legal basis for the order and voiced more practical concerns.

“Is this happening in the delivery room?” Justice Ketanji Brown

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INSIDE

Hope for shuttered hospital?

The owner of the now-shuttered West Suburban Medical Center said Wednesday he hopes to reopen the hospital this summer — but a state lawmaker who represents the area is questioning whether that plan will become a reality. **Business**



Tall task: Illinois was no match for UConn in November. Can what coach Brad Underwood calls a “different” Illini team fare better in a Final Four rematch? **Sports**

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